

Modern Savage — Launch Critical Path & Blocker Map

As of 7 July 2026 · Built by Junior for Jesse *The tactical execution layer under Business Plan v2.1. One source of truth. Every open item, who owns it, what it blocks, and what breaks if it slips. The strategy is settled; this is about getting the launch out the door.*

The one-line status

Everything downstream is waiting on one 15-minute email from Drew. The US run is in production, the company is banked, packaging is decided, the audience is built. The single item gating labels, packaging artwork, and the entire UK manufacturing track is the finalised formula spec sheets from ACF. That is now 13 days overdue. Nothing else on this list is genuinely stuck.

Launch targets (anchor dates)

Milestone	Date	Notes
Bear's Health Optimisation Show tags MS releases	22 Jul	Free reach into exactly our audience. First public signal.
Bison shoot, Rhug Farm (Jesse + Olly)	13 Jul	Content bank for launch. ASA guardrail below.
US launch	September	Ahead of Bear's HOS (12 Sep). Gated on labels + packaging, both of which need specs.
UK launch	4-8 weeks behind US (late Oct / Nov)	Fully gated on spec-sheet handover to Protein Partners.

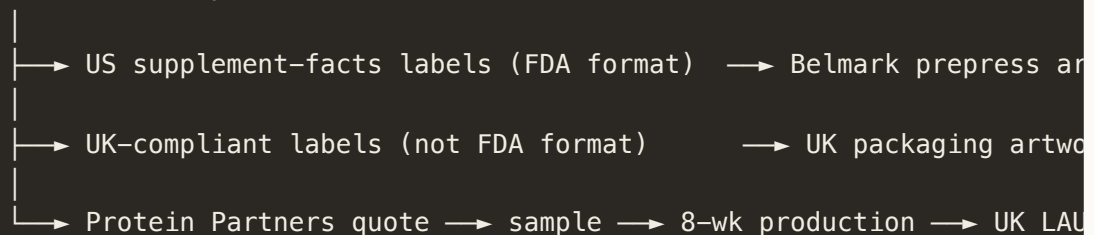
The September US window has slack **today**. It stops having slack the moment Belmark prepress and label sign-off get compressed against the print + fill lead time. Every day Drew is silent eats that slack.

THE CHOKEPOINT — ACF / Drew spec sheets

Status: Promised 24 Jun. Chased 1 Jul. Unanswered as of 7 Jul. **Owner of the ask:** Jesse / CJ. **Bear's line:** "It's our property. Just ask for it."

What it blocks (the dependency chain)

ACF final formula spec sheets



Read that top to bottom: the specs are the founding document of **both** label sets, **both** packaging artworks, and the **only** thing that lets Protein Partners even quote. This is not a second-wave nicety anymore. It is the root node of the whole tree.

Escalation ladder (my recommendation)

Step	Trigger	Action
1 — Direct chase	Now	CJ sends Drew a one-line, deadline-stamped request: "Please send the final spec sheets for all 3 SKUs by EOD Thu 10 Jul. They're our property and they're now blocking the UK manufacturer."
2 — Escalate to relationship	No reply by Fri 11 Jul	Jesse goes over Drew directly to the ACF/Lightning principal. Frame it as a business-continuity issue, not a favour.
3 — Reconstruct in parallel	No reply by Mon 14 Jul	Do not stay hostage. We hold the approved samples, the COGS model, and the formula summary. Have Protein Partners work from the ingredient deck + a lab reverse-spec of an approved sample. Slower and costs a sample run, but it removes Drew from the critical path entirely.

The point of step 3: the single biggest risk to this launch is not Drew saying no, it is Drew saying nothing for six weeks. Set the 14 Jul trigger now so the decision to route around him is automatic, not another thing that waits on a meeting.

Open items — full board (7 Jul)

#	Item	Owner	Status	Blocks	Deadline
1	ACF spec sheets	Jesse/CJ→Drew	🔴 13 days overdue	Everything below in labels/artwork/UK	Thu 10 Jul (escalate)
2	US supplement-facts labels	MS/design	🟡 Waiting on #1	Belmark prepress	On specs +3 days
3	Belmark prepress + print (Soft Touch Matte, 3 SKU)	Belmark (Sarah S.)	🟡 Ready to go, waiting on artwork	US fill	\$150/SKU, fast once fed
4	US run balance payment (~\$88K of ~\$163K)	Raemy	🟡 \$82K paid	US units complete	Per ACF schedule
5	Stripe build	Felix	🟡 Chase KYC done 1 Jul; Stripe next	Checkout / taking money	Before US launch
6	UK manufacturer — Protein Partners quote	Jesse	🔴 Gated on #1	Entire UK track	On specs
7	UK fulfilment (3PL)	Ops (unfilled)	🔴 TBD	UK delivery	Before UK launch
8	Jesse's >10% MS personal stake — papered	Raemy	🟡 Agreed w/ Bear, not documented	Clean cap table	Before external money
9	UK trading structure / VAT	Raemy	🟡 Flagged 2 Jul	UK entity setup	Before UK run
10	NMN novel-food call (UK Summit SKU)	Jesse/legal	🟡 Open	UK Summit spec	At quote stage, not after

#	Item	Owner	Status	Blocks	Deadline
11	Ops / GM hire	Jesse	🔴 Biggest structural gap	Owns #7, day-to-day exec	ASAP — job spec built
12	ASA cleanup — remove April AI testimonial videos from site	Felix/Calvin	⚠️ Verify	Compliance exposure	Before any paid push

Legend: 🔴 blocked/critical · 🟡 in motion · ⚠️ verify

What CAN move right now (parallel work, zero dependency on Drew)

Do not let the chokepoint stall the things it does not touch:

1. **Stripe build (Felix)** — banking's done, this proceeds independently. Get checkout live.
2. **Bison shoot 13 Jul** — content bank. Fully independent. See guardrail below.
3. **Ships A Lot US onboarding** — agreement signed ~30 Jun; get the operational handshake done (SKUs, barcodes, receiving) so the moment stock ships it flows.
4. **UK fulfilment shortlist** — start the 3PL search now so it's not a cold start when the UK run lands.
5. **Ops/GM hire** — the job spec exists. This is the single highest-leverage thing Jesse can start today, because #7, #9, and half this board should not be on Jesse's desk at all.
6. **ASA sweep** — verify the April AI testimonial videos are actually off the live site. Cheap to do, expensive to get wrong once there's paid traffic.
7. **Papering Jesse's stake + UK VAT structure (Raemy)** — neither needs Drew. Clear them before external money or the UK entity forces the question at the worst time.

Two things to protect (guardrails)

ASA / bison provenance (13 Jul shoot). The pouch bison liver is **not** Rhug-sourced. No on-camera language, caption, or edit can imply the product contains Rhug bison. Brief Olly before the shoot, not after.

The Rhug upside worth grabbing while you're there. Separate from the shoot: ask Rhug about **supplying bison liver for the UK manufacturing track** (Protein Partners). Rhug is the largest UK bison herd with a Royal Warrant. A named-source UK product is a moat no US competitor can copy, and it turns a content trip into a supply-chain win. Worth raising in person on the 13th.

If I were running your week

1. **Today:** CJ fires the deadline-stamped spec chase at Drew (step 1). Set the 14 Jul route-around trigger in writing so it fires itself.
2. **This week:** Felix pushes Stripe live. You move on the ops/GM hire — that's the constraint behind half this board.
3. **13 Jul:** Rhug shoot with the guardrail, and float the UK bison-supply ask to Rhug in person.
4. **By Fri 11 Jul:** if Drew's still dark, you go over his head to the ACF principal.
5. **Standing rule:** nothing on the "parallel work" list is allowed to wait on the spec sheets. They're on different tracks — keep them there.

The launch is not at risk from strategy or money. It's at risk from one silent supplier and one unfilled ops seat. Fix those two and September holds.

No personal data in this brief. Reconciled from Business Plan v2.1, the 2 Jul financial model, the 30 Jun packaging decision, and the 1 Jul business audit. Owners named are internal team roles. — Junior